

TEN IMPORTANT OPEN SOURCE WEBSITE BUILDING TOOLS



Here are 10 open source site building tools you should know of, ranging from Liferay through to Joomla.

A Content Management System (CMS) or Web Management System is an application or suite of applications to manage the content of a website. It helps in managing content, collaboration and the easy administration of content without the requirement for deep expertise in technology platforms. It often comes with a Web-based GUI, the facility to index and search documents, role-based access, graphical workflow, digital asset management, remote access, extensibility, reusability of content, user-specific marketing, etc. For an IT organisation, it serves as a repository to efficiently store and retrieve information such as project documents, the latest technologies, explorations, best practices, podcasts, videos, etc. The most common examples of CMSs are those used for enterprise content management, Web content management, portal content management, document management, digital asset management, etc.

Liferay

The Liferay Portal is an open source enterprise portal for building websites and Web applications written in Java and distributed under the GNU Lesser General Public License and commercial licences. It is a Web platform with the features commonly required to develop websites and portals by assembling portlets or gadgets onto a portal page. It has the capability of making things easier when displaying diverse data based on different roles such as admins and normal users. For example, in a college portal, the sys admin, students, teachers, etc, each have different pages or sections available for them to access and interact with.

The Liferay Portal is an enterprise Web platform providing self-service portals, dynamic Web 2.0 websites, content and

document management with Microsoft Office integration, enterprise collaboration, identity and access management, social networking, application integration, a unified document repository, and an asset publisher to display any data contained within the portal to create workspaces for customer websites, Intranet, collaboration platforms, and group websites. It also provides text editors with spell-check and text styling capabilities, reusable templates for Web pages and page sections, capabilities to add comments and notes into templates, user-driven workflow and approval, live page editing and scheduling, staging and easy website planning, document conversion and multi-file uploads, faceted and multi-tier search, multi-language support, dynamic tagging, and SEO.

The Liferay Portal is Java based, and is capable of running the JRE and an application server bundled with a servlet container such as Apache Tomcat 7.0.42 as of now.

Website: <http://www.liferay.com/>

Alfresco

Alfresco is an enterprise CMS available in different flavours. Alfresco One provides hybrid ECM (enterprise content management) that includes on-premise as well as cloud deployment of Alfresco with robust synchronisation capabilities between the two. It has capabilities of document management, Web content management, repository-level versioning, records management, image management, and content management support for learning management systems. It has supported the concept of an open source ECM since 2005. Alfresco continues to be the only vendor with an open source ECM offering in Gartner's recently released